

School Email Survival

What you'll build: a 30-second system for the 900-word PTA email, the crumpled backpack flyer, and the reply you keep putting off.

School communication is a part-time job you never applied for. Three prompts turn it back into something that takes seconds.

The steps

1 The long-email decoder

Copy the whole email, paste it after this prompt:

COPY THIS PROMPT Here's an email from my kid's school. Tell me: 1) What do I actually need to DO? 2) By when? 3) Does it cost money? Short bullet points only.
Email: [paste it here]

2 The reply you've been avoiding

COPY THIS PROMPT Draft a short, friendly reply to my kid's teacher saying [what you need to say — e.g., 'Emma will miss Friday for a family thing, what will she need to make up?']. Warm but brief — 3 sentences max.

Read it, tweak one word so it sounds like you, send. The 20 minutes you usually spend rewriting? Gone.

3 The backpack flyer trick

That crumpled paper about spirit week or picture day? Take a photo of it and send the photo to Claude with: *"What do I need to know, do, and pay — and what dates go on my calendar?"* Yes, it can read the photo.

Level up

Once these feel easy, connect Claude to your Gmail and it can watch for school emails on its own — that's exactly what the [Morning Briefing lesson](#) sets up. School stuff just shows up in your daily summary.

Privacy note: school emails can include your kid's full name and details. That's fine for summarizing — but it's a good habit to leave out anything you wouldn't want in an email yourself, like medical details, when you can.

That's the system. Decode, reply, photograph. The PTA will never slow you down again.